Office of the Secretary of State
Mobile Work Policy
Frequently Asked Questions

1. Who is eligible to mobile work?

Ability to mobile work is determined by position tasks, business need, and employee status. Employees who are non-permanent or in trial service/probationary status are not eligible to mobile work. If you have questions about whether the position is mobile-work eligible, please work with your Human Resource Consultant.

2. What is situational mobile work?

Situational mobile work occurs when an employee works from their office the majority of the time, but needs to work elsewhere occasionally, on an as-needed basis.

3. Can I mobile work each week on a set schedule?

If your position and you are eligible, yes. There are two categories: Hybrid or 1-2 days, and 3+ Days for those who work three or more days remotely each week. Hybrid is more common and may be approved at the division level. Employees applying to work 3 or more days, must work with their supervisor, director, and seek approval from Executive Management.

4. If an employee travels regularly as part of the position description (for site visits, trainings or conferences), does that person need to fill out a mobile work agreement when this type of mobile work occurs? In this case, is a VPN token required?

Yes. This may fall into the situational category. It will ensure the employee receives a VPN and utilizes state-issued equipment.

5. What is considered a reasonable leave balance?

This is determined by the Division Director and/or Deputy, and there is no set number of hours due to varying circumstances. For instance, an employee who just completed a probationary period is not likely to hold a large leave balance. Length of time on the job, leave abuse, and FMLA usage, are all considerations in this determination.

6. Should mobile work be added to the position description?

Yes, if the position is eligible for mobile work. However, the position description designation is only *one* step in the application process for mobile work. The employee and the supervisor must complete assessments, sign an agreement, and seek the appropriate approvals.

7. Who monitors the mobile work agreement?

The supervisor and appointing authority or director will sign and monitor the mobile work agreement. In the first year, these agreements should be revisited quarterly and signed annually thereafter. Requirements to mobile work include the ability to send mobile work logs and measurable work. These tools help determine whether the agreement is effective.

8. What must the employer provide to the mobile worker?

The employee will be provided with the necessary state-issued equipment. This can include a laptop, VPN token, and smart phone. However, setup of an ergonomically-sound mobile workspace is an employee responsibility.

9. How is mobile work managed?

Mobile work is managed in each division to ensure business needs are continually met. HR may be involved in determining position eligibility as one step and in maintaining signed mobile work agreements that now must be stored in personnel files.

**OFM has some resources on their website regarding mobile work strategies.

https://www.ofm.wa.gov/facilities/building-modern-work-environment/connectivity